

SaaS Customer and Subscription Analysis

Analysis period: January 2023 – August 2026

Executive Summary

This analysis investigated customer subscription activity, net payment revenue across plans, showing industries that make up the most customer base, and comparing number of active customer's overtime with the number of those who cancelled their subscription service. This analysis has 2,500 customers, 3,300 subscriptions, 18,000 payments, 30,00 product usages, 4,200 support tickets, and 18 marketing campaigns.

The analysis shows a SaaS business with a growing customer base and strong revenue generation, particularly from Retail customers and higher-value subscription plans. Revenue increased substantially from 2023 through 2025, although the available 2026 data show a softer trend.

At the same time, the business has a substantial number of cancelled subscriptions, while payment failures, refunds and customer support activity indicate areas where customer retention and the overall customer experience could be strengthened.

The main opportunity is therefore not simply acquiring more customers, but retaining existing customers, improving payment reliability, and converting strong customer usage into longer-term subscription value.

Findings

Customer Growth and Customer Profile

- The business has 2,500 customers, with the customer base increasing from 793 in 2023 to 879 in 2025.
- SMBs make up the largest customer segment, with **1,383 customers**, followed by Mid-Market customers at 812 and Enterprise customers at 305.
- Retail is the largest industry represented, with **479 customers**, while Healthcare has the smallest customer base at 392.

Business implication

The business has established a broad customer base rather than relying on a single industry or customer segment. However, the relatively small Enterprise customer base represents an area where higher-value accounts could potentially contribute more revenue if successfully acquired and retained.

Recommendation

Continue supporting the large SMB customer base while developing targeted strategies for Mid-Market and Enterprise customers. These customers may need more specialised onboarding, account management, and product support.

Revenue Performance

- Total net revenue across the analysis period was **R13.99 million**.
- Revenue increased significantly:
 1. **2023:** R1.62 million
 2. **2024:** R4.03 million
 3. **2025:** R4.90 million
 4. **2026:** R3.42 million through August
- The 2026 figure should not be directly compared with the full-year figures because only January–August is included.
- Retail generated the highest industry revenue at approximately **R2.73 million**, followed by Professional Services at R2.33 million and Finance at R2.32 million.
- The total number of subscriptions by plan is not equivalent to the highest revenue generating subscription plan. The starter subscription plan has the most subscribers but has the least revenue outcome.
- By subscription plan, Business generated the highest net revenue at approximately R4.39 million, followed by Professional at R4.21 million.

Business implication

- Revenue growth has been strong, but the 2026 monthly figures show some weakening toward the middle of the year. This makes customer retention and recurring revenue particularly important.
- The Business plan's strong contribution also suggests that higher-value plans are an important part of the company's revenue base.

Recommendation

Monitor revenue and recurring revenue trends monthly rather than relying only on annual totals. Attention should be given to customers moving away from higher-value plans or cancelling them.

Subscription Retention and Cancellations

- There are 3,300 subscriptions, of which:
 1. **772 are active**
 2. **2,528 are cancelled**
- This means approximately **77% of recorded subscriptions are cancelled**.
- Cancellation levels are relatively similar across plans, with each subscription plan recording more than 70% of cancellations.

1. Starter: 77.3%
2. Business: 77.1%
3. Professional: 75.7%
4. Enterprise: 75.7%

- The consistency across plans suggests that cancellations are not isolated to one particular pricing tier.

Business implication

- The high proportion of cancelled subscriptions is one of the most important findings in the analysis. Even though the business is generating substantial revenue, continued acquisition can become expensive if customers do not remain subscribed for long enough.
- The data should not automatically be interpreted as a current 77% churn rate because the dataset contains subscriptions that began at different points in time. However, it clearly highlights the need to investigate customer retention.

Recommendation

For management to help identify which customers are most likely at risk of leaving and why they leave, they ought to investigate whether customer tenure is related before cancellation, usage levels, or cancellations following payment failures have an impact.

Product Usage

- Automation generated the highest number of sessions at approximately **15,390**, followed by API at 15,195 and Reporting at 14,997.
- Retail customers also show strong engagement across several features.

Business implication

- There does not appear to be one overwhelmingly dominant feature. Instead, customers are using several parts of the platform.
- This provides an opportunity to improve retention by understanding which combinations of features are associated with longer subscription periods and higher-value customers.

Recommendation

Management may want to analyse feature usage alongside subscription outcomes. For example, identify whether customers who regularly use Automation, API or Reporting have longer subscription lifetimes or higher-value plans. This could help the business focus onboarding and customer education on features that contribute to continued product adoption.

Payments and Revenue Leakage

The payment data contains:

1. **16,427 paid payments**
2. **1,074 failed payments**
3. **499 refunded payments**

- Failed and refunded payments represent a meaningful amount of revenue activity and should not be overlooked.
- The analysis records approximately R813,604 associated with failed payments and R385,799 associated with refunds.

Business implication

Payment failures can create unnecessary revenue leakage and may contribute to customers eventually cancelling their subscriptions. Refunds can also indicate payment disputes, dissatisfaction, or other problems in the customer journey.

Recommendation

Management may want to implement stronger payment-recovery processes, such as:

- Automated retry attempts for failed payments
- Customer notifications before or after payment failure
- Monitoring customers with repeated payment failures
- Analysing the reasons behind refunds
- Linking payment problems with subsequent cancellations

The objective should be to distinguish between temporary payment issues and genuine customer dissatisfaction.

Customer Support

- The business recorded 4,200 support tickets.
- Billing was the most common issue type with 856 tickets, closely followed by technical issues with 855 and Account issues with 852.
- Average ticket resolution time was approximately 48 hours, while the overall average satisfaction score was approximately 3.0 out of 5.
- Billing tickets had the lowest average satisfaction score at approximately **2.9**, despite having the highest ticket volume.

Business implication

Billing appears to be an important customer-experience pain point. Customers are contacting support frequently about billing-related issues and are also giving relatively lower satisfaction scores for these interactions.

Recommendation

Investigate the main causes of billing tickets and simplify the billing experience where possible.

The business could also monitor support performance using KPIs such as:

- Average resolution time
- First-response time
- Satisfaction score
- Repeat tickets
- Tickets per active customer
- Support volume by issue type

This would make it easier to identify recurring problems rather than treating every support ticket as an individual issue.

Customer Acquisition

- Referral and Organic Search were among the largest customer acquisition channels, with 526 and 525 customers respectively.
- Referral customers generated approximately R2.97 million in net revenue, while Organic Search generated approximately R2.82 million.
- Campaign-level acquisition costs varied considerably. Some campaigns acquired customers at substantially lower costs than others, indicating significant differences in campaign efficiency.

Business implication

The business is not dependent on a single acquisition source, but acquisition performance varies considerably. Spending more on a channel does not necessarily translate into proportionally better customer acquisition.

Recommendation

Evaluate acquisition channels using both customer volume and customer value.

Rather than measuring campaigns only by the number of customers acquired, management should consider: This would provide a more meaningful view of which acquisition activities create sustainable growth.

Conclusion

The SaaS business demonstrates strong revenue generation, a growing customer base and broad product usage across industries and features. Retail and the Business subscription plan are particularly important contributors to revenue.

The main challenge is maintaining that growth sustainably. The high number of cancelled subscriptions, combined with payment failures, refunds and relatively modest support satisfaction, suggests that customer retention and customer experience deserve as much attention as new customer acquisition.

This analysis is based on the available dataset and the static dashboard and pivot-table outputs. The dashboard does not provide interactive filtering, so the findings describe overall-patterns retrieved from SQL analysis rather than allowing users to dynamically investigate individual customer segments.